

Ishmael Nii Obido Ayettey

208 E Mulberry St Normal, IL 61761 • ishmaelayettey@gmail.com • +1 309-612 5230
<http://www.linkedin.com/in/ishmaelayettey>

Professional Summary

A strategic problem-solver who connects operational details to big-picture goals. With experience in financial audit, risk consulting, and advanced analytics, I focus on generating high-impact, actionable insights which has mitigated over \$200K in financial exposure. I specialize in transforming complex data into strategic direction, delivering recommendations that enhance Total Quality Management (TQM) and optimize resource efficiency.

Education

Illinois State University

Normal, IL

Master of Business Administration (STEM), Business Analytics. GPA: 3.89/4.0

May 2026

- Honors: IMA Certified Management Accountant Scholarship (awarded to <2,000 students globally).
- Relevant Coursework: Advanced Organizational Strategy, Marketing Analytics (**R & SQL focus**), Brand Management (**Python & ML focus**).

University of Professional Studies

Accra, Ghana

Bachelor of Science in Business Administration

August 2018 – June 2022

Experience

Technology Solutions Specialist | Illinois State University | Normal, IL

September 2024 – Present

- Provisioned and configured Windows and macOS endpoints, managing imaging, software deployment, and asset lifecycle inventory for faculty and staff devices.
- Administered Apple devices via **JAMF** and supported Windows environments with **SCCM**; automated setup using **PowerShell** scripts for network drive mapping and Active Directory OU transitions.
- Built and maintained Excel-based inventory and reporting dashboards (Power Query, PivotTables), improving data accuracy by **20%** and supporting budget and refresh planning.
- Delivered Tier 1–2 support through ServiceNow, Cherwell, and Cisco IP queues, resolving hardware, software, printer, and classroom technology issues in coordination with Networking and A/V teams.

Audit Consultant | DKF Professionals | Ghana

October 2023 – July 2024

- Led comprehensive risk assessments and operational analyses for telecom and manufacturing clients, identifying procurement and supply chain inefficiencies that posed a \$200,000+ financial risk.
- Utilized SQL and Excel models to quantify control gaps, transforming data into clear insights for stakeholder discussions. This data-driven approach secured C-suite buy-in for strategic recommendations, **reducing compliance risk by 40% and increasing operational efficiency by 15% quarterly**.

Audit Assistant | Ghana Audit Service | Ghana

November 2022 – October 2023

- Analyzed financial and operational data for high-impact government audit engagements, modeling anomalies (Excel, regression) to develop insights that informed strategic policy recommendations and strengthened public sector accountability.

Projects

- **Strategic Capstone (MBA 485):** Conducted Value Chain Analysis for global firms and managed real-time airline operations in a competitive business simulation to drive superior firm performance and competitive advantage.
- **Predictive Analytics (MKT 445):** Engineered a semester-long research project using **R** and **SQL** to build **Logistic/Poisson Regression** models and performed **Text Mining** on customer reviews to extract actionable insights.
- **Brand Analytics (MKT 440):** Authored an SEO client report using **SEMrush** and **GA4** and utilized **Python** with **Machine Learning** (clustering) to develop interactive **Tableau** dashboards for C-suite stakeholders.
- **AI Integration:** Leveraged **ChatGPT** and **Gen AI** across advanced analytics workflows to optimize coding, data preparation, and technical troubleshooting in **RStudio** and **Python** environments.

Leadership & Volunteer Experience

Volunteer Income Tax Preparer | IRS VITA Program | Normal, IL

January 2026 – Present

- Interviewed and filed taxes for 100+ clients by **gathering requirements** and identifying **tax credits** on a case-by-case basis while ensuring **100% regulatory compliance** with IRS guidelines to maximize refunds for diverse individuals and families

Peer Mentor | University of Professional Studies | Accra, Ghana

January 2021 – June 2022

- **Mentored 15+ freshmen** by providing tailored academic and social guidance, organizing workshops on study strategies and time management, and acting as a liaison to faculty to improve resource accessibility and preparedness.

Skills & Interests

Analytics & Programming: Python | SQL | R/ R Studio | Power BI/ Tableau | Advanced Excel (VBA, Data Modeling) | SEMrush/ SEO

Quantitative & Statistical Modeling: Regression Analysis | Forecasting | Hypothesis Testing | A/B Testing | Financial Modeling (NPV, IRR, DCF)

Audit, Risk & Compliance: SOX, GAAP, & IFRS Compliance | Risk Assessment | Forensic Audit | Financial Reporting & Analysis

Business Strategy & Operational: Strategy & Project Management (Agile, Scrum, Value Chain Analysis, KPI Development, Presentations, Requirement gathering) | Operational Finance (Financial Planning, Budgeting, ERP Systems) | IT Service Management (ServiceNow, Cherwell, Microsoft Office)

Machine Learning: Clustering (K-means, Hierarchical) | Classification | Predictive Modeling | Gen AI & Prompt Engineering

Certifications & Additional Information

- **Certifications:** Google Analytics 4 Certification | Data Analytics Certification (Explore AI in partnership with ALX)-**Mastercard funded**.
In Progress: Certified Public Accountant (CPA) -Illinois | Certified Management Accountant (CMA).